Maiwand Nangyal

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Citizenship: British

Education

- **University of Oxford** — Oxfordshire, UK
  DPhil in **Economics**; with full scholarship. **10/2024 - 12/2027**
- **University of Oxford** — Oxfordshire, UK
  MSc in **Economic & Social History**; with full scholarship. **10/2023 - 08/2024**
- **University of Cambridge** — Cambridgeshire, UK
  MPhil in **Economics**; with full scholarship. **09/2020 - 08/2021**
- **University of Exeter** — Devon, UK
  BSc (Hons) in **Economics**; with 18/20 "Firsts"; 3/3 annual commendations. **09/2016 - 06/2019**

Research Interests

Primary: Development Economics, Economic History, Political Economy.
Secondary: Applied Econometrics, Machine Learning.

Skills Summary

Languages:	English (native), Pashto (native), Dari, Urdu and Hindi.
Methods:	Econometrics, Impact Evaluations/Measurement, Machine Learning, Natural Language Processing, Agent-based Dynamic Microsimulation Modelling.
Programming:	Stata, R, Python, Julia, SAS (E-Guide, Studio, E-Miner), SQL, Java.
Modelling, Visualisation & Tools:	AnyLogic, QGIS, Mathematica, Excel, Word and PowerPoint.
Documentation:	LaTeX, Overleaf and R Markdown.

Scholarships, Grants and Awards

Scholarships and Studentships

2023-2027 **ESRC Grand Union DTP Studentship**
Full scholarship (fees and stipend) for MSc and DPhil at the University of Oxford.

2020-2021 **Cambridge Trust Scholarship**
Full scholarship (fees and stipend) for MPhil at the University of Cambridge.

Grants and Awards

2027 **UKRI International Placement Scheme Award** £8,500
Funded research placement at the Library of Congress, Washington DC, USA.

2026 **World Bank Group Placement Grant** £5,195
ESRC funding for the Outcome Measurement Unit placement, IBRD, WBG.

2024 **Faculty and College Travel Grant** £425
History Faculty, University of Oxford and Hertford College, University of Oxford grant for a research trip to Islamabad, Pakistan.

Honours

2016-2019 **Dean's and School Commendations**
Awarded 3/3 annual academic commendations at the University of Exeter; consistently ranked in the top 5%–10% of cohort (≈250 students).

Work-in-Progress

- **The Game of Thorns: Opium Cultivation and Conflict in Afghanistan, 1994-2021.**

Teaching and Mentoring

- **University of Oxford** Oxford, UK
  Graduate Teaching Assistantship **01/2026 - Present**
  - **Economics for Economic Historians** (MSc/MPhil) 01/2026 - Present
    Teaching microeconomics, macroeconomics, and applied econometrics to postgraduate students in Economic and Social History.

Term	Course	Teaching	*n*
Hilary 2026	4.55	4.45	33
Michaelmas 2026	TBC	TBC	–

Student feedback, scale 1–5.

  - **Economics of Developing Countries** (3rd-year UG) 10/2026 - Present
    Teaching weekly 90-minute tutorials for the Department of Economics and Oriel College to five groups of finalists (PPE, E&M, History and Economics) and visiting students; leading tutorial discussions and giving detailed feedback on weekly essays and problem sets covering poverty and inequality, health, growth, trade, education, migration and institutions.

- **RISE Research** Remote (Part-time)
  Research Mentor **11/2025 - Present**
  - Supervising students across the US, the UAE, India, and the UK on original economics research projects over 8-week programmes, guiding them from research design to publication-ready papers.

- **Lumiere Education** Remote (Part-time)
  Research Mentor **07/2026 - Present**
  - Supervising students in the US, China, India, Kazakhstan, and Bahrain on original economics research projects across three programme tracks: Individual Research (up to 9 sessions), Premium Research & Publication (up to 15), and Research Fellowship (up to 30).

Experience

- **World Bank Group (IBRD)** Remote
  Outcomes Measurement Unit, Department for Outcomes **02/2026 - 05/2026**
  - ESRC-funded placement with World Bank Group and University of Geneva researchers contributing to research on the $4 trillion sustainable development financing gap, gaining exposure to benchmarking and developing standardised impact measurement frameworks aligned with UN Sustainable Development Goals and evaluating metrics against pre-defined performance criteria.
  - Systematically compiled a corpus of academic papers across leading economics and finance journals using targeted climate-relevant JEL codes, combining direct journal filtering with structured EconLit searches; forming a reusable climate finance literature database.
  - Collected climate impact metrics from practitioner reports across DFI and asset manager signatories; developed a Python script to automate report downloading at scale and prepared a taxonomy document with per-signatory commentary and aggregate coverage analysis.

- **Data for Afghanistan** Remote (Voluntary)
  Advisor **02/2025 - Present**
  - Providing technical advice, working with **Dr Ahmad Zia Wahdat** to compile datasets and visualisations on Afghanistan - one of the world's most data-scarce, conflict-affected, and impoverished countries - for empirical research (**URL**).

- **UK Civil Service - Department for Work and Pensions** Westminster, London, UK
  Fast Stream Economist **Post-DTA (SEO-equivalent)** **09/2021 - 09/2023**
  - Selected for the flagship UK Civil Service Fast Stream graduate scheme from 56,667 applicants in 2019-20 (overall 2019-20 offer rate: 2.3%; Economics stream offer rate: 14.9%; **source**).

- **Post 1: Contract Management & Partner Delivery Division (Finance Group)**
  - Led two employment programme impact evaluations worth £1 billion using Propensity Score Matching on HMRC/DWP microdata, line managing a Statistician, with results informing ministerial policy decisions.
  - Conducted real-time analyses using SAS and SQL, delivering accurate responses to ministerial briefings, Freedom of Information requests, and Parliamentary Questions under tight deadlines.
- **Post 2: Working Age Modelling and Forecasting Division (Policy Group)**
  - Contributed to the development, validation and successful launch of a department-critical agent-based dynamic microsimulation model in AnyLogic/Java covering ≈6 million Universal Credit claimants using billions of observations, integrating machine learning-derived model inputs and securing stakeholder approval for outputs.
  - Applied advanced SAS programming (Enterprise Miner & Studio) to merge DWP datasets, optimising complex variable interactions and achieving significant runtime efficiency.
- **Grade Manager for DWP Economist Placement Students (08/2022 - 09/2023)**
  - As one of three Grade Managers, led end-to-end recruitment and assessment of placement economists across the Government Economic Service, coordinating with Chief Economists and HR whilst overseeing sifting, logistics, and assessment moderation.
  - Provided pastoral and professional support to placement economists, coaching them through technical assessments and mock interviews in economic theory, introducing structured exit surveys, and adapting communication to diverse audiences, from senior leadership to volunteers and across technical and non-technical colleagues.

Presentations

- **Oxford Political Economy Workshop, Department of Economics (06/2026)**: Presented 'The Game of Thorns: Opium Cultivation and Conflict in Afghanistan, 1994–2021'; audience included Dr Eric Chaney and Professor Jean-Paul Carvalho (Associate Editor, *Quarterly Journal of Economics*).
- **Oxford Graduate Seminar in Economic and Social History [agenda], Nuffield College (11/2025)**: Presented DPhil Chapter 1 research; received feedback from faculty and graduate students.
- **32nd Annual Graduate Workshop [agenda], Nuffield College (04/2024)**: Presented MSc dissertation research; audience included Professors Sheilagh Ogilvie and Joel Mokyr (joint 2025 Nobel laureate in Economics) and incorporated their feedback into the final dissertation.

Panel Participation

- **Oxford Prospects Programmes**, Merton College **08/2026**
  DPhil panellist for the summer access programme, on graduate study and life at Oxford.

Conferences, Seminars & Workshops

Attended; presentations listed separately above.

2026: **Associate Fellowship of the HEA (AFHEA) Workshop**, Oxford, UK.
ESRC Grand Union DTP Annual Conference, Oxford, UK.
Introduction to Teaching at Oxford, Oxford, UK.
Stephen Broadberry's Work in the Very Long Run, 1982–2026, Oxford, UK.

2025: **OWL (Oxford-Warwick-LSE) Annual Workshop**, Oxford, UK.
ESRC Grand Union DTP Annual Conference, Oxford, UK.
Oxford Department of Economics Political Economy Seminar, Oxford, UK.
CSAE Lunchtime Seminar, Oxford, UK.

2024: **Oxford Economic & Social History Graduate Seminar**, Oxford, UK.
Oxford Department of Economics Political Economy Seminar, Oxford, UK.
CSAE Lunchtime Seminar, Oxford, UK.

2023: **DWP Work, Pensions & Labour Economics Study Group Conference**, Sheffield, UK.
Oxford Economic & Social History Graduate Seminar, Oxford, UK.

2022: **Government Economic Service Annual Conference**, London, UK.
Fast Stream Conference, Westminster, London, UK.

2021: **Bristol Festival of Economics**, Bristol, UK.

Extra-Curricular Activities

- **Research Groups & Seminars**
  University of Oxford **10/2023 - Present**
  - Oxford Centre for Economic & Social History
  - Oxford Centre for the Study of African Economies
  - Oxford Department of Economics Political Economy Research Group
  - Oxford Centre for Global History
  - St Antony's Asian Studies Centre
  - Oxford Centre for Islamic Studies
  - Oxford Dept. of Economics Machine Learning & Economics Reading Group

- **Professional & Academic Memberships:**

  Academic (Oxbridge) *(lifelong memberships upon matriculation; dates reflect period of study)*

  - Wolfson College, University of Oxford **10/2024 - Present**
  - Hertford College, University of Oxford **10/2023 - 08/2024**
  - St Edmund's College, University of Cambridge **09/2020 - 08/2021**

  Academic

  - Royal Economic Society **02/2026 - Present**
  - Economic History Society **09/2025 - Present**

  Professional

  - Society for Professional Economists **08/2022 - 08/2025**
  - Government Economic Service **09/2021 - 09/2024**
  - Civil Service Fast Stream **09/2021 - 09/2024**
  - HM Civil Service **09/2021 - 09/2024**

- **Library Readerships**
  - Library Reader, All Souls College, University of Oxford **10/2023 - Present**

- **Professional Development**
  upReach **10/2016 - 03/2020**
  - Selected for the upReach professional development programme; Gold Award recipient.

References

References available upon request; I kindly ask that you contact my referees only with my prior agreement.

Professor Stephen Broadberry
Department of Economics
University of Oxford
Profile: **View Profile**
Email: **Contact**

Dr Eric Chaney
Department of Economics
University of Oxford
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Professor Sriya Iyer
Faculty of Economics
University of Cambridge
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